

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about health ‘mistakes’:

Common health ‘mistakes’

Every day, we make common health ‘mistakes’ that may affect our health in general. Making a few simple changes to your daily routine may save your life. Below are some examples of health ‘mistakes’.

1. Showering every day A daily hot shower using harsh, dry soaps can be bad for your skin. “Using hot water combined with harsh soaps can remove the skin’s oils and moisture, resulting in dryness, cracking and even infection of the skin,” said a doctor.
2. Sleeping too little Getting less than 6-8 hours of sleep a day greatly affects your health, no matter how much you exercise. Scientists have discovered that those who skipped sleep increased their risk of stroke and heart disease by 400%.
3. Carrying a heavy bag Carrying a heavy schoolbag or handbag around can really hurt your health by causing back pains, neck problems and poor posture, according to experts.
4. Over-exercising It’s wrong to think that the more time we spend exercising, the better our health. Working your body too hard can lead to a weaker immune system, muscle damage, and knee, foot, or back problems.
5. Skipping breakfast Skipping breakfast not only makes you feel tired and less active, it is also linked with a higher risk of diabetes and can lead to obesity as your body stores up more fat to use as energy throughout the rest of the day.

Your group wants to organize a workshop about common health ‘mistakes’. Discuss with your group what to include in the workshop. You may want to talk about:

- how common these health ‘mistakes’ are in Hong Kong
- the top three ‘mistakes’ to choose for the workshop
- how to make the workshop interesting
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you eat breakfast every day?
2. Do you sleep more than six hours a day?
3. Do you agree that breakfast is important?
4. What can schools do to solve the problem of heavy schoolbags?
5. Which health ‘mistake’ is most surprising to you?
6. Which is worse – over-exercising or under-exercising?
7. Should we trust health information found on the Internet?
8. Do attitudes towards health habits change over time?

DO NOT TAKE AWAY